FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC IDAH
DEPARTMENT OF SOFTWARE AND WEB DEVELOPMENT

COURSE TITLE: OPERATING SYSTEM
COURSE CODE : SWD 311
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QUESTION

Research on the two type of diskette?

ANSWER

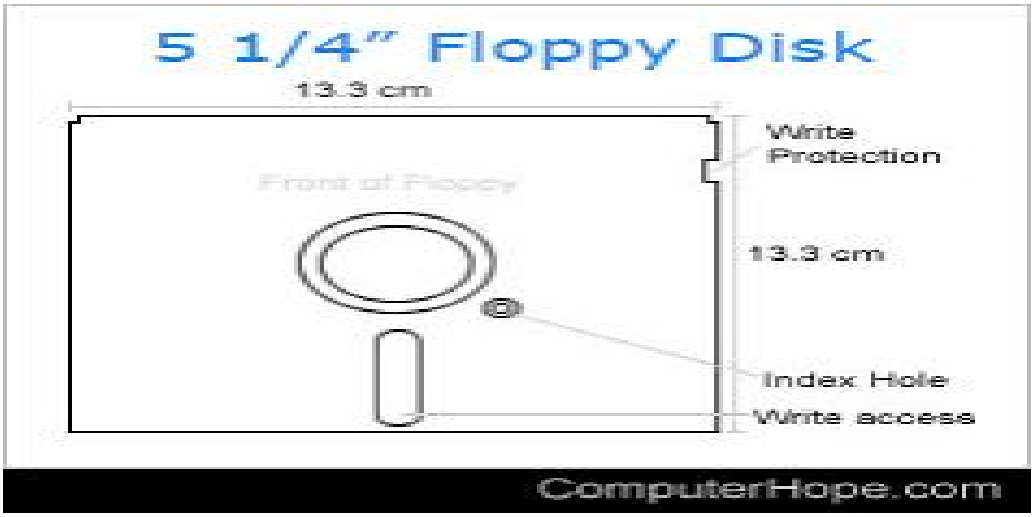
Diskettes, also called floppy disks, were magnetic storage devices used in early computers to save files, transfer data, and install software. They consist of a thin magnetic disk enclosed in a protective casing. Over time, two major types of diskettes became widely used: the 5.25-inch

diskette and the 3.5-inch diskette.

THE TWO TYPE OF DISKETTE

1. The 5.25-Inch Diskette
2. The 3.5-Inch Diskette

THE 5.25-INCH DISKETTE



The 5.25-inch diskette was the first commonly used floppy disk. It was introduced in the late 1970s and became popular in the early personal computer era.

Features

- It is large and flexible, made of a thin magnetic disk inside a soft square plastic cover.
- The diskette has a large circular hole in the center and a small notch on the side to enable or protect writing.

Storage Capacity

- Early versions stored 160 KB to 360 KB, while later high-density versions stored 1.2 MB.
- Although small by modern standards, this was sufficient for simple programs and documents of that time

Usage

- Used in early computers like IBM PCs, Apple II, and other early desktop systems.
- Mostly used for loading operating systems, saving programs, and transferring small files.

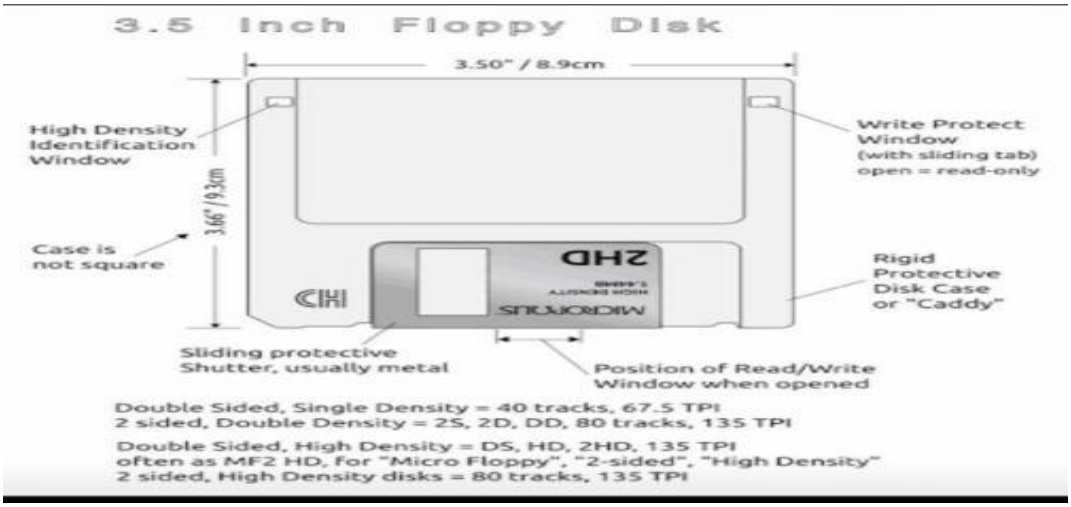
Advantages

- Cheaper to produce.
- Widely supported by early computer systems.

Disadvantages

- Very delicate and easily damaged by dust, heat, bending, or fingerprints.
- Low storage capacity compared to later devices.
- Vulnerable to magnetic interference.

THE 3.5-INCH DISKETTE



The 3.5-inch diskette came later and improved on the weaknesses of the 5.25-inch type. It became

the most widely used floppy disk in the 1990s.

- Features
- It is smaller, stronger, and more durable, with a hard plastic shell.
- It has a metal sliding shutter that protects the magnetic disk from dust and scratches.
- Usually includes a write-protection switch to prevent accidental file deletion.

Storage Capacity

- Standard capacity is 1.44 MB (most common).
- Some special versions could store up to 2.88 MB.

Usage

- Used for storing school files, documents, software installation, and computer backups.
- Common in desktop and early laptop computers before USB flash drives became popular.

Advantages

- More durable and reliable than 5.25-inch diskettes.
- Smaller and portable.
- Better data protection due to hard casing and shutter mechanism.
- Disadvantages
- Still limited in storage by modern standards.
- Became obsolete with the rise of CDs, DVDs, USB drives, and cloud storage.

CONCLUSION

Both the 5.25-inch and 3.5-inch diskettes played important roles in the history of computer storage. The 5.25-inch diskette was the pioneering format, while the 3.5-inch diskette improved durability and storage capacity. Today, they are mostly obsolete but remain important in understanding the evolution of computer technology.